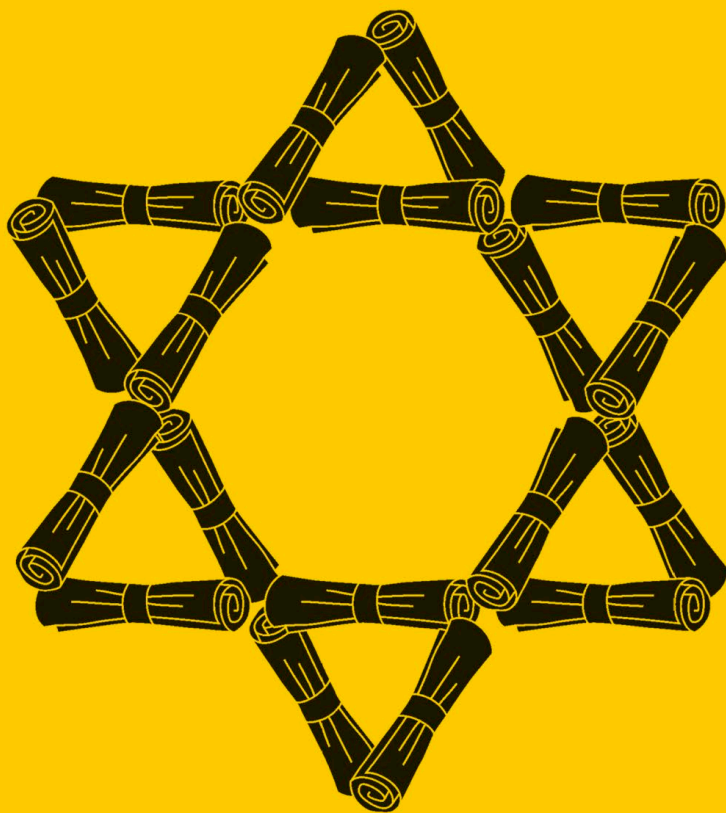


JUSTICE, TRUTH, AND PEACE

THE MISHNAH AND THE TALMUD
(c. 200—c. 500 CE)



IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Divine law

BEFORE

516 BCE King Cyrus of Persia allows the Jews exiled in Babylon to return to Jerusalem and rebuild their Temple.

70 CE Following a Jewish revolt, the Romans sack Jerusalem and destroy the Temple.

AFTER

c. 1070–1105 In France, Rabbi Shlomo Yitzaki (Rashi) writes a commentary on the Talmud.

1240 The Talmud is put on trial in Paris and condemned for blasphemy. Every copy in France is burned.

1519–1523 In Venice, Italy, Daniel Bomberg publishes the first printed copy of the Babylonian Talmud.

The Talmud (“Study”) is a written compendium of Jewish oral laws that govern every part of a devout Jew’s life. Made up of the Mishnah and the Gemara, it is the central text of Rabbinic Judaism, which emerged after the Romans destroyed the Temple in Jerusalem in 70 CE, and is the mainstream form of Judaism.

The Romans had ruled Jerusalem and the surrounding province of Judea from the 1st century BCE onward—at first through client kings, and later through governors. In the 1st century BCE, Judaism divided into rival forms, each taking a different attitude toward Jewish law. Temple worship was overseen by the